

# What makes good wildlife photography

## 优秀的野生动物摄影有什么特征

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优秀的野生动物摄影师不止要运用技术能力，还需要有韧性和对大自然的深切尊重。比如，一位获奖的野生动物摄影师用了十年才拍摄到了一只鬣狗在一个废弃城镇的照片。而仅通过这样一张照片来激发人们对动物保护的热情对摄影师来说更是需要对照片构图的巧思。本文浅谈优秀的野生动物摄影通常具有哪些特征。

词汇: wildlife 野生动物

**1** Can you imagine waiting ten years to take the perfect photograph? With phones accessible in our pocket, it's easier than ever to take photos of nature and wildlife, providing we can find it. But what skills do the most successful wildlife photographers have? Talent, patience, curiosity and resilience .

**2** The winner of Wildlife Photographer of the Year 2025 was South African wildlife photographer Wim van den Heever. His shot depicts a brown hyena lit up in an abandoned mining town in the Namibian desert and was the culmination of ten years' work. So why was it so difficult to capture? The subject is a shy creature, mostly active at night, and the Namib Desert often succumbs to thick fog, while easterly winds can pile sand up to a metre high. "I had one or two years where cameras just got absolutely trashed ," he says.

**3** The images captured in this competition are not just stunning , they are also powerful glimpses into the fragile, complex and beautiful ecosystems we share. The picture that won Young Wildlife Photographer of the Year 2025 is of a longhorn beetle appearing to look out at big logging machinery which is chopping down its habitat . The photographer has cleverly framed the beetle and machinery to be equal in size, which one of the judges commented on. "The photographer has given M. asper authority in this image. It does exactly what a strong photograph should do – it increases our understanding."

**4** A strong visual can not only provoke the urgency of conservation but can also give us glimpses into the unexpected. This year a Belgian photographer captured a startling image of one of the world's only maritime lions. These big cats moved from their traditional hunting grounds in the Namib Desert in 2017 and have since learnt to hunt fur seals along the Atlantic coast. "The photo shows how resilient these animals are... that they change their habitat to survive," says the photographer, Van Malderen.

**5** What wildlife could you capture? Grab your phone, explore nature and see what you can find.

## 测验与练习

### 一、为本文选择总结句。

1. Which statement is true? a. The most important quality a wildlife photographer needs is resilience. b. The best wildlife photographers highlight the impact of humans on nature. c. A range of skills are needed to be a successful wildlife photographer.

### 二、根据文章内容选出正确的选项。

1. One reason it took Wim van den Heever so long to take his winning picture was... a. because the environment is difficult to work in. b. because brown hyenas are so rare. c. because his cameras were continuously ruined.

2. What does 'it' refer to in the following sentence? So why was it so difficult to capture? a. the photograph b. the town c. the desert

3. The longhorn beetle was hard to photograph because of its size. a. True b. False c. Not given

4. The young photographer framed the image so that... a. the beetle was larger than the logging equipment. b. the beetle was the same size as the logging equipment. c. the beetle was smaller than the logging equipment.

5. Why could the maritime lions be described as 'unexpected'? a. Because they have changed where they live and what they hunt. b. Because they are very difficult to photograph. c. Because they are a successful result of human conservation efforts.

### 三、用下列单词完成对本文的总结。

For Wim van den Heever to capture his 1) \_\_\_\_\_, it took ten years - 2) \_\_\_\_\_ is a necessary quality for a successful wildlife photographer. Telling a story and being able to 3) \_\_\_\_\_ conversations around 4) \_\_\_\_\_ are also important these days, particularly with 5) \_\_\_\_\_ changing and wildlife having to adapt so quickly.

ecosystems provoke maritime habitat conservation resilience subject

(答案见词汇表后)

## 词汇表

### accessible

容易取得的 resilience 韧性 depict 描绘 hyena 鬣狗 mining 采矿 culmination 顶点, 完结 subject (拍摄的) 对象 succumb 受...影响, 屈服于... pile 堆积起来 trash 损坏, 严重破坏 stunning 极漂亮的 ecosystem 生态系统 longhorn beetle 天牛 logging 伐木, 用于伐木的 habitat 栖息地 frame 框在镜头中 authority 威信, 权威 provoke 激起 conservation (对动植物的) 保护 startling 惊人的 maritime 海上的 big cat 大型猫科动物 fur seal 海狗

## 答案

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### 一、为本文选择总结句。

c. A range of skills are needed to be a successful wildlife photographer.

### 二、根据文章内容选出正确的选项。

1. a. ...the Namib Desert often succumbs to thick fog, while easterly winds can pile sand up to a metre high .
2. a. His shot depicts a brown hyena lit up in an abandoned mining town in the Namibian desert and was the culmination of ten years' work. So why was it so difficult to capture?
3. c. Not given. There is no mention of the size of the beetle or it being hard to photograph.
4. b. The photographer has cleverly framed the beetle and machinery to be equal in size ...
5. a. These big cats moved from their traditional hunting grounds in the Namib Desert in 2017 and have since learnt to hunt fur seals along the Atlantic coast. "The photo shows how resilient these animals are... that they change their habitat to survive ".

### 三、用下列单词完成对本文的总结。

For Wim van den Heever to capture his subject it took ten years – resilience is a necessary quality for a successful wildlife photographer. Telling a story and being able to provoke conversations around conservation are also important these days, particularly with ecosystems changing and wildlife having to adapt so quickly.

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